Solo Feral to 60. Restoration after.

A leveling and dungeon guide for the Normal PvE ruleset

Level as **Feral** all the way to 60. Start in caster form, use Bear from 10, and do most solo quests in Cat from 20. Tank in Bear whenever a convenient group comes together. At 40, open a Restoration second spec and heal a few dungeons. At 60, make Restoration your main group role and keep Feral for soloing, tanking and occasional Cat DPS.

Biggest detours worth taking
Do the Bear quest at **10** and the Cat quest at **20**. Take **Lacerate at 25**, train **Travel Form at 30**, and line up **Dire Bear, Primal Bite and dual spec at 40**.

The class quests to plan around

10 | Bear Form. Night Elf: see your trainer, go through Darnassus and Moonglade, then finish Body and Heart east of Auberdine. Tauren: the equivalent runs through Thunder Bluff and Moonglade, then west of Camp Taurajo. Skyborne: take Strength and Mercy from Urs'endris on Zephras Isle and approach the quest cave from the north.

14-16 | Utility. Pick up Cure Poison when available. Aquatic Form opens at 16 and is worth doing if your route includes coastal or underwater quests. Start it then and finish the travel-heavy steps near 18-20 if that fits your path.

20 | Cat Form. Start your race's Great Cat Spirit chain with the trainer. Set your Hearthstone before using Teleport: Moonglade. Recover the three relics in the Stormrage Barrow Dens and finish the chain. Put Prowl, Claw and Rip on your Cat bar. Train Omen of Clarity.

Which route should you follow?

Night Elf: Alliance, Teldrassil to Darkshore. **Tauren:** Horde, Mulgore to the Barrens. **Skyborne:** Zephras Isle to about 12, then follow your chosen faction column. Darkshore or Westfall works for Alliance. The Barrens works for Horde.

Classic routes still help with familiar hubs and roads. Use Forever sources for the Cat quest, weapon scaling, talent tiers, spell ranks, loot and new zones. This plan assumes the usual talent points starting at 10.

Sources [01] [02] [03] [04] [05] [16]

Levels 1-29

Quest in clusters. Use the listed dungeons when the group and travel line up.

LEVEL	ALLIANCE	HORDE	WHAT TO DO
1-9	**Teldrassil** Shadowglen to Dolanaar.	**Mulgore** Red Cloud Mesa to Bloodhoof Village.	Skyborne start in **Zephras Isle**. Open with Wrath, use Moonfire when the mob will live or you need an instant tag, and heal between pulls. Favor one mob at a time.
10-15	Finish nearby Teldrassil quests, then **Auberdine** in Darkshore. **Westfall** is the alternative.	Finish Mulgore, then **the Crossroads** in the Barrens. Add Ratchet quests when nearby.	Do Bear immediately. Learn Maul and Growl, then Enrage when available. For a first tank run, try **Hall of Thanes** (13-18, easier Alliance access) or **Ruins of Lordaeron** (15-20, easier Horde access). Level 16 is a comfortable first attempt.
16-19	**Darkshore** out of Auberdine. Use Westfall and Sentinel Hill if the coast is crowded.	**The Barrens** out of the Crossroads and Ratchet. Save the longer southern circuits for later.	Train Swipe at 16 and Faerie Fire at 18. Try Bear on two ordinary mobs once comfortable. Optional **Deadmines** or **Wailing Caverns** toward the upper end. Pick up the flight paths and finish any convenient Aquatic steps.
20-24	**Ashenvale** from Astranaar. Eastern alternative: **Redridge** from Lakeshire into early Duskwood.	**Stonetalon** from Sun Rock Retreat, or **Ashenvale** from Splintertree Post. Finish Barrens quests that share a loop.	Stop for Cat Form at 20. Prowl past extras and use Cat on singles. Feral Charge at 20 gives Bear an interrupt. Train Rake, Ferocious Bite and Remove Curse at 24. Optional **Excavation Site** (24-29) if near Wetlands.
25-29	**Duskwood** from Darkshire or **Wetlands** from Menethil. Finish Ashenvale if the quests are still good.	**Southern Barrens to Freewind Post** in Thousand Needles. Use Tarren Mill in Hillsbrad if you are already east.	Take Lacerate at 25 for sturdy targets. Use Rake and Rip when they have time to tick. Try one healing run with your caster gear if you want early practice. **City of Dalaran** (28-33) is an optional detour with an entry quest.

When to move on: Finish quests you can turn in together. Switch hubs when the board is mostly low-value, long errands, elites, or mobs well above your level. Pick up every flight path you pass and bind to the inn for your current cluster.

Dalaran access: Alliance starts An Alarming Request in Southshore. Horde starts Key to the City and Prison Break-In in Tarren Mill.

Sources [03] [04] [05] [06] [07] [08]

Levels 30-60

Follow one main loop per bracket and use the alternate zone to fill gaps.

LEVEL	PRIMARY SOLO ROUTE	MILESTONE AND OPTIONAL GROUP RUN
30-35	**Alliance:** Northern Stranglethorn from the Rebel Camp or Arathi from Refuge Pointe. **Horde:** Shimmering Flats in Thousand Needles, then northern Stranglethorn from Grom'gol or Arathi from Hammerfall.	Train Travel Form and take Leader of the Pack at 30. Group: finish **City of Dalaran** or use a nearby Classic dungeon. Train Frenzied Regeneration at 36.
36-40	**Riverglades** is the main route. Alliance starts at Farholde Keep. Horde starts at Rog'mar. Kalimdor alternative: **Desolace into Shen'dralas** if the Valley of Bones chain is available.	The **Drowned City** (35-40) fits a Stranglethorn detour. Riverglades is roughly 36-44, and Shen'dralas is a shorter midlevel detour. At 40, visit a trainer for Dire Bear, Innervate and dual spec.
41-45	Finish **Riverglades**, then sail from Powderfuse Port to Steamwheedle Port for **Tanaris**. Use **Feralas** if you are already in western Kalimdor.	Try **Krol'dok Stronghold** (40-45) as Dire Bear or use it as your first Deep Resto run. Train Barkskin at 44. Gather your group before taking on the Riverglades arena chain.
46-49	**Tanaris** from Gadgetzan, then **Feralas** from Feathermoon Stronghold (Alliance) or Camp Mojache (Horde). If staying east, use Hinterlands or Searing Gorge.	A quest-stacked **Zul'Farrak** run is a good healing practice session. Try **Alcaz Prison** (48-53) if your group is headed to Dustwallow Marsh.
50-54	**Un'Goro** from Marshal's Refuge for compact circuits. Then **Felwood** for the Kalimdor finish or **Western Plaguelands** for the eastern finish.	Start comparing healing pieces instead of vendoring them. A **Blackrock Depths** run fits if you are already in the eastern zones and have quests ready.
55-57	**Winterspring** from Everlook after Felwood, or **Western to Eastern Plaguelands** if you stayed east. Add **Mount Hyjal** through Darkwhisper Gorge when the approach is comfortable.	Heal a **Blackmaw Hold** run (55-60, Azshara) or a Classic high-level dungeon with a group near your route.
58-60	Finish in **Mount Hyjal, Winterspring or Eastern Plaguelands**. Pick the closest zone with available quest clusters. Silithus is a backup if you have a convenient flight path.	**Shaper's Terrace** (58-60, Un'Goro) is the last new five-player leveling option. Start your faction's Onyxia chain if you plan to raid.

Riverglades travel. Enter by road from northern Redridge or southern Badlands, or use the Tanaris boat. Grab the flight point at Farholde Keep (60.6, 81.6) or Rog'mar (59.6, 45.0).

Sources [01] [06] [07] [08] [09] [10]

Every talent point

A solo-first build with early Swipe damage and enough Bear tools for regular five-player tanking.

LEVEL	SPEND IN THIS ORDER
10-19	10-14 Ferocity 5/5. 15-17 Feral Instinct 3/3. 18-19 Feral Swiftness 2/2.
20-29	20 Feral Charge. 21-22 Sharpened Claws 2/2. 23-24 Savage Fury 2/2. 25 Lacerate. 26-28 Predatory Strikes 3/3. 29 Blood Frenzy 1/2.
30-39	30 Leader of the Pack. 31 finish Blood Frenzy. 32-34 Furor 3/5. 35-39 Rend and Tear 5/5.
40-49	40 Primal Bite. 41 Predatory Discipline. 42 Shifting Power. 43-47 Heart of the Wild 5/5 (Restoration). 48-49 start Naturalist.
50-60	50-52 finish Naturalist 5/5. 53-55 Reflection 3/3. 56-60 Genesis 5/5 (Balance). Final split: 5 Balance / 33 Feral / 13 Restoration.

If tanking becomes your second job: Swap the five late Genesis points for Natural Reaction in Feral for Bear dodge and rage. For a dedicated level-60 Bear build, start from the linked tank guide and decide how much Cat damage you want to keep.

Cat for regular quest mobs

Open from Prowl if it saves travel, lets you get behind a target, or sets up a useful opener. Use **Claw** while face-to-face and **Shred** from behind. Use **Rake** and a 4-5 point **Rip** when the target will live long enough. Use **Ferocious Bite** as a finishing hit or against bleed-immune targets. Skip the finisher if an auto-attack will do it. Use Shifting Power when low on energy and comfortable on mana.

Bear for packs, elites and dungeon tanking

Before pulling, keep Mark of the Wild and Thorns up. Pull with Faerie Fire when available or use line of sight to move casters. On packs, **Swipe early** and rotate targets. On sturdy targets, build **Lacerate** stacks and use **Primal Bite** once learned. Use **Maul** when you have rage to spare. Save **Growl** for a mob that leaves you, then follow with threat. Use Feral Charge or Bash to stop a cast.

Start with small pulls, mark a kill target and check your healer's mana. Use Demoralizing Roar on harder melee packs. For dangerous pulls plan Frenzied Regeneration and use Barkskin proactively. Heal between solo pulls, or root a mob to make room for a heal.

Sources [02] [03] [04] [05] [11] [16]

Two sets, one character

Keep useful healing pieces from the 20s onward and build the set deliberately in the 40s.

ROLE	LOOK FOR	HOW TO USE IT
Cat questing	A strong weapon DPS upgrade, then useful Agility and Strength. Stamina helps when the mobs hit hard.	Form attacks scale with equipped weapon DPS in Forever. Compare the weapon's DPS and useful stats. Use a staff or mace you can equip rather than following a Classic stat-stick list.
Bear tanking	Armor, Stamina and Agility for survival. Weapon DPS still matters for damage and threat.	Keep a few sturdier pieces for your Bear swap. At 60, build out a proper tank set before harder runs and use the Forever tank guide for encounter-specific stat tradeoffs.
Restoration	Intellect and Spirit while leveling. Add +Healing as good pieces appear. At 60, prioritize +Healing with Intellect, Spirit and mana per 5 seconds (MP5) to sustain longer fights.	Cloth is usable when it improves healing. Carry a healing weapon or off-hand, water and mana potions. Keep your healer gear together so you can change sets before the first pull.

What to train when gold is tight

Early: Wrath while you still cast to kill, then Maul, Swipe, Faerie Fire and your main self-heals. Keep current ranks of Claw, Rip and Rake once you use Cat. Pick up Prowl and key control or recovery spells as they appear. Revive at 12 and Rebirth at 20 cover different jobs.

Later: Buy the important new ranks for your chosen form and the heals you actually cast. Prioritize Travel Form, Dire Bear, Innervate and Barkskin when available. Pick up Lacerate upgrades after taking the talent and Primal Bite's trainer ranks at 50 and 60. Delay unused offensive caster ranks while Feral.

Save time between pulls

Keep enough mana to heal yourself and shift back. Use Regrowth before a tougher solo pull and drink when low. In Cat, run or Prowl while energy refills. Keep Track Humanoids, Dash and Aquatic Form available when the route benefits. Log out at an inn and buy enough bag space to avoid frequent vendor trips.

Gold at 40: Pay for your key skills and the Restoration slot if you want to practice healing immediately. Travel Form gives you a practical fallback if riding has to wait. Read the trainer's live quote before budgeting for dual spec.

Sources [02] [04] [05] [11] [12]

Start healing at 40

Use Deep Restoration for your first five-player runs. Keep Feral as your open-world and off-role build.

A dungeon-first build that grows with you

At 40 | 31 Restoration: Spend in this order: Heart of the Wild 5, Nature's Focus 5, Naturalist 5, Reflection 3, Gift of Nature 5, Bloom 1, Improved Rejuvenation 3, Swiftmend 1, Nature's Swiftness 1, Improved Regrowth 1, Wild Growth 1.

41-51 | 11 Balance: Genesis 5, Nature's Majesty 2, Nature's Reach 2, Improved Wrath 1, Nature's Splendor 1. **52-60 | Finish Restoration:** Improved Regrowth +4, Living Spirit 3, Improved Tranquility 2. Final split: **11 Balance / 0 Feral / 40 Restoration**.

Five-player healing priorities

SITUATION	ACTION
Predictable damage	Use Rejuvenation on the tank when sustained damage is coming. Use Regrowth for meaningful damage that also benefits from its heal-over-time effect. Start a heal early if the next hit will be big.
Urgent single target	Swiftmend a target with your own Rejuvenation or Regrowth. It leaves that effect in place. For a large instant save, use Nature's Swiftness with Healing Touch.
Several players hurt	Cast Wild Growth when several members of the same party will benefit. Its base cast is 3 seconds (2.5 with Naturalist 5), so plan ahead. Save Tranquility for a safe window of sustained party damage.
Mana and utility	Use an Omen of Clarity proc on a useful expensive heal. Drink between pulls and use Innervate early enough to get the benefit. Use Remove Curse or poison dispels for dangerous effects. Revive out of combat and use Rebirth for a valuable combat resurrection.

Enable visible party health, debuffs and your own HoT timers. Put Swiftmend, Nature's Swiftness, dispels and Innervate on easy binds. Once your gear improves, add a lower rank of Regrowth as a mana-saving option for lighter damage.

At 60: List as a healer and run the dungeon your group is ready for. For raid healing, compare Deep Resto with Nature's Grace / Improved Regrowth after your raid leader knows which assignments need steady group healing or faster spike recovery.

Sources [02] [05] [12] [13] [16]

Your first week at 60

Heal most groups. Keep a separate Feral set so you can switch roles when a group needs you.

1. Run five-player dungeons as Restoration. Start with a convenient group for Blackmaw Hold, Shaper's Terrace, Blackrock Depths, Stratholme or Scholomance. Upgrade your weakest pieces. The phase-one loot list is still being filled in. Use it alongside live drops and crafted options such as Mooncloth Gloves or Mender's Leather pieces.

2. Keep your off-role useful. Stay Feral for solo farming and bring the Bear set to tank. For Cat DPS in a group, use your Cat gear and Shred from behind when practical. Tell the group which role you are joining for and agree on off-spec rolls before the run.

3. Prepare for raids if you want them. Blizzard lists December 9 for Barrow Deeps (10), Hyjal Summit (20), and Onyxia's Lair (40). For Onyxia, Alliance starts with Dragonkin Menace in Burning Steppes, and Horde starts with Blood and Thunder in Kargath. The chains go through high-level dungeons and end with the Drakefire Amulet. Keep it in your bags.

Sources and in-game references

01 Blizzard launch overview · Normal ruleset, new zones and launch content
02 Blizzard class deep dive · Dual spec and weapon scaling
03 Blizzard launch tuning · Feral and Restoration tree changes
04 Icy Veins Druid class quests · Bear, Aquatic and Cat walkthroughs
05 Icy Veins Feral leveling · Rotations and milestones
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09 Wowhead Riverglades guide · Hubs, coordinates, entrances and boat
10 ByteTavern zone levels · Live Hyjal and recorded Shen'dralas ranges
11 Wowhead Forever Bear builds · Tank talents and role variants
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13 Blizzard launch hotfixes · Swiftmend tooltip correction
14 Blizzard raid overview · Dates, group sizes and both Onyxia chains
15 Wowhead Restoration gear · Phase-one gear and item sources
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Also checked Icy Veins healing priorities, Mobalytics Feral leveling, Forever client spell levels and Wowhead Classic Feral.